

## ANGEL ACTION · ENVIRONMENTAL

# Heat Exhaustion and Heat Stroke

Heat exhaustion is treated by moving to a cool place, removing clothing and sipping cool water. Heat stroke is a life-threatening emergency — call 000 and cool the person rapidly by any means available.

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## Heat exhaustion

**Signs:** heavy sweating, pale clammy skin, headache, nausea, weakness, dizziness.

1. Move to a cool, shaded area.
2. Loosen or remove clothing.
3. Cool with damp cloths and a fan.
4. Sip cool water or oral rehydration solution.
5. Rest until fully recovered.

## Heat stroke — life threatening

**Signs:** hot dry skin (sweating may have stopped), high body temperature, confusion, slurred speech, collapse, seizures.

1. **Call 000.**
2. Move to a cool place.
3. **Cool rapidly** by any means — cold water immersion is best; otherwise spray with water, fan, ice packs to the neck, armpits and groin.
4. If unconscious but breathing, place in the **recovery position**.
5. Do NOT give anything by mouth if drowsy or confused.

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*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at [firstaidangel.org](https://firstaidangel.org).*